

Incident Classification and Escalation Policy

Document POL-09 | Version 2.0 | Approved | Effective 2026-09-01

Owner: Operations Manager. Approval authority: Managing Director. Scope: All employees. Review due: 2027-09-01. Valid until: No scheduled expiry.

Purpose and application

Coordinate timely responses to security, safety and major service incidents with consistent severity, ownership and evidence.

4.1 Critical escalation

REQ-POL-09-01 | Mandatory

Employees must notify the duty Operations Manager within 15 elapsed minutes of discovering a critical incident. Immediate emergency or containment actions must not wait for a ticket; the notification record must follow as soon as practical.

Evidence: Discovery time, severity basis and notification timestamp.

4.2 Severity classification

REQ-POL-09-02 | Mandatory

Employees must classify an incident as critical when it involves immediate physical danger, suspected exposure of customer data or complete loss of dispatch capability. Where severity is uncertain, they must escalate as critical pending review.

Evidence: Severity assessment linked to observed facts.

4.3 Incident record

REQ-POL-09-03 | Mandatory

The first available responder must create an incident record containing observed facts, discovery time, affected services and initial actions. Speculation must be labelled and credentials must be excluded.

Evidence: Incident record with factual timeline.

4.4 Single incident owner

REQ-POL-09-04 | Mandatory

The duty Operations Manager must appoint an incident lead and record the handover. IT leads technical containment while the incident lead coordinates business decisions and communications.

Evidence: Named lead and accepted handover.

Incident Classification and Escalation Policy continued

4.5 Evidence preservation

REQ-POL-09-05 | Mandatory

Responders must preserve relevant logs, messages and event identifiers without modifying originals. Evidence access must be restricted to the response team and a preservation hold applied where necessary.

Evidence: Evidence inventory and preservation reference.

4.6 External communication

REQ-POL-09-06 | Mandatory

Only the incident lead or a designated spokesperson may issue incident updates to merchants or customers. Updates must distinguish confirmed impact from investigation assumptions.

Evidence: Approved message and distribution record.

4.7 Incident closure

REQ-POL-09-07 | Mandatory

The incident lead must record recovery evidence, outstanding risks and corrective action owners before closure. The Operations Manager must review critical incidents within 2 working days after restoration.

Evidence: Closure checklist and post-incident review.

4.8 Response rehearsal

REQ-POL-09-08 | Recommended

Teams are encouraged to rehearse one incident scenario each month and document a specific improvement to the response procedure.

Evidence: Optional rehearsal notes.

Training and control

Employees learn the applicable clauses during Week 1 and complete a source-based knowledge check. Task performers demonstrate the relevant procedure before independent work. Mandatory knowledge checks require at least 80 percent; all safety and privacy critical steps must pass. The assessor records requirement IDs, evidence and the source version. An earlier operational deadline still applies. Questions and exceptions follow POL-01; related controls include POL-01, POL-03, POL-05, POL-06 and POL-09.